

YOU MURDERER!

How you killed the art of photography,
and how tech helped you do it...

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I'm not used to arguing. I usually just write my piece and then I'm done with it. It's easy to have an opinion... What's that saying? "Opinions are like @r\$3|-|0|_3\$, everyone has one", and I am certainly one. Arguments are very different though, which means I have to (*ugh*) rely on facts and "prove" my stance. How boring. Here goes nothing.

While you have already read the other undercover writer's opinion, and perhaps been swayed by it, you should now forget all of it, because, as usual, I'm right, and here's proof:

ARTISTS

Most arguments against the stance we've taken on our cover are just creative ways of playing hide the ball with the facts. Although I haven't read the opposing view (and am not allowed to read it until it's published), I assume that it will boil down to arguments of popularity. If billions of people are clicking photographs now, surely that means that the art of photography is alive and kicking, right?

Well, a large amount of people think Justin Bieber, Miley Cyrus and Nicki Minaj are "artists", or worse, "musicians". If you're one of them, put this magazine down now, I have nothing more to say to you. Call me a "purist", but I prefer music that actually has some meaning and requires real talent to make.

Similarly, just because billions of photographs are vomited out of smartphones and cheap cameras the world over doesn't mean they're photography art. If anything, people's social media accounts are beginning to look like the old albums our parents and grandparents like to pull out to embarrassingly show your friends your overexposed baby pictures. What I'm trying to say is, the pictures we take are crap, and given that we can immediately see that they are crap after clicking them (which our grandparents couldn't), us still uploading them proudly says something. Something not nice.

We've seemingly become bored of photography as a herd, and poor videos and bad pictures are everywhere. Even those of us who take time

and effort seem to be clicking pouty faces with filters that make us look as unrealistic as possible. The beauty of capturing a subject, raw, and real, and telling a story through photographs still exists, and there are enough and more professionals who continue to be dedicated to that task. Heck, we've got an interview with one such person a little later. But they're not the masses, they're not the direction we're headed in, and they're under-appreciated.

Photoshop and other software made it easier for those who couldn't set up subjects to perfection, or know the ins and outs of their equipment (as professionals do). Flaws were being covered up, and then eventually, features that didn't exist were being added on. Even simple HDR modes are essentially unrealistic. Whatever it is, it isn't photography... it might be the digitising of painting, but it's not photography.

TECH

Technology, as usual, kept going, and making the entry point to everything much easier. Not only that, it made everything cheaper (which is great for everyone), but what it also did was try to cover up for our inherent lack of skills, and adding on effects left right and center. Smartphones added basic levels of AI to their camera software, to try and auto adjust several parameters to (usually) get a much better photograph than you could have managed on your own without help. The end result? All of the above comes together to make us appreciate the pains of the art of photography less. It's why many of us went out and bought entry-level DSLRs, only to shoot with Auto mode all the time. That's when we use them, of course, because more and more people are ditching the DSLR for a good phone.

Now, before you throw a tantrum about your own experience and how you love your DSLR and lovingly kiss it goodnight before you sleep... and how so many more people you know are buying DSLRs... the numbers just don't add up sadly. DSLR sales are slumping*, and it should be growing given simple popula-

* Sources:

<http://dgit.in/LowCamSls>

<http://dgit.in/RIPCmpctCam>